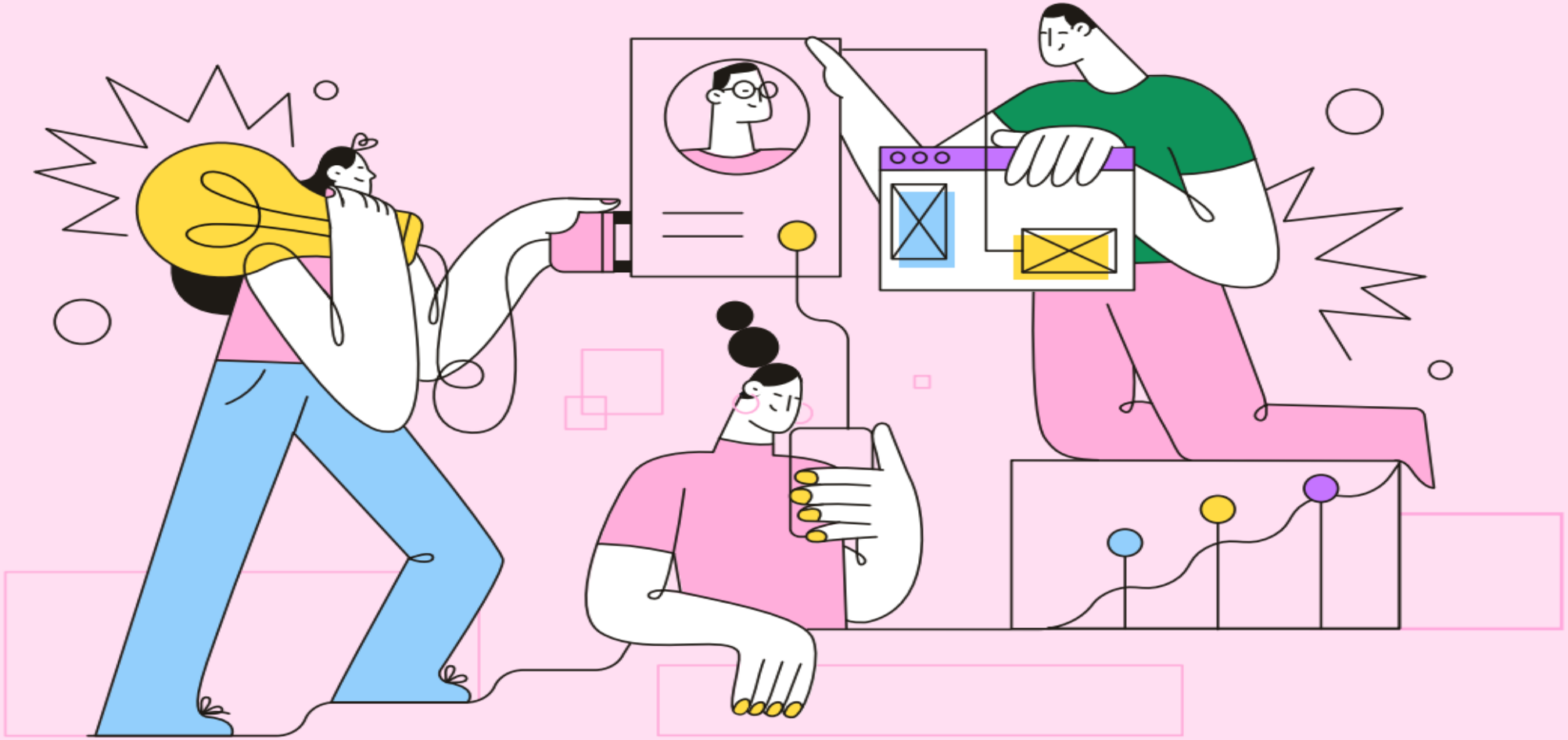
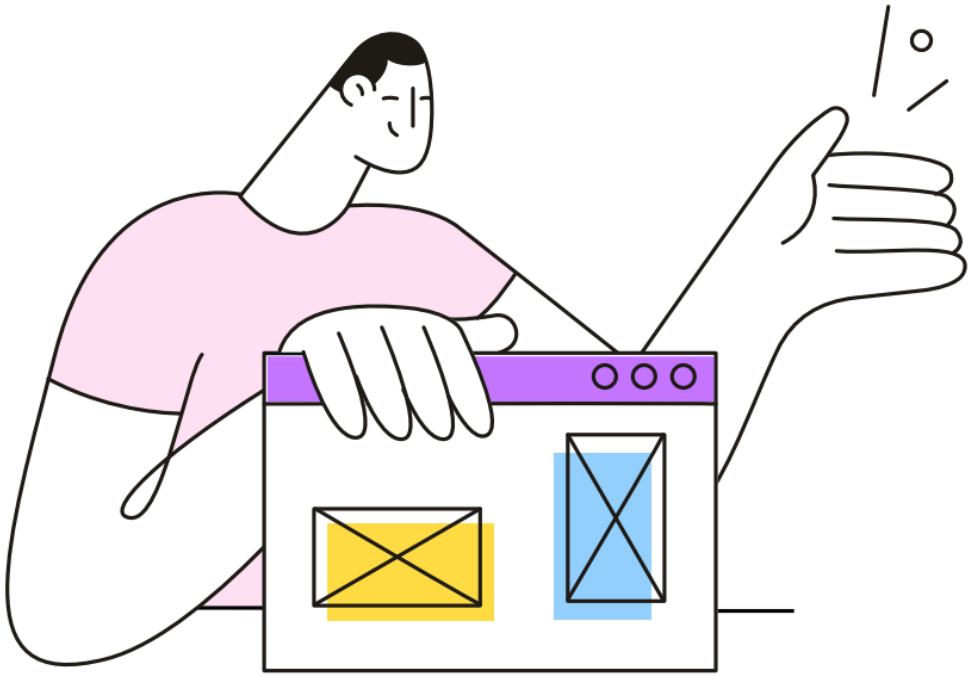


Workbook

The Design Thinking Workshop Kit



— *First up*

What is Design Thinking?

Design Thinking is a set of principles that helps you go from an idea right the way through to a testable prototype, with the user's needs at the center of every decision.

Empathise with people

Know the people you're designing for, so you understand their needs better.

Define a challenge

Decide on who you want to design for and what you want to help them do.

Ideate possibilities

Come up with different solutions that might be useful to people - remember there are no bad ideas!

Prototype your design

Create a user flow and turn your ideas into interactive mockups.

Test your design

Take your prototypes to your audience and get feedback.

Stage 01

Empathise with people

Know the people you are designing for, so you can understand their needs better.

Build the profile of your end-user and try to see the world through their eyes

The first stage of Design Thinking helps develop empathy towards your potential end-user and will be the guiding light when you move toward brainstorming solutions.

You'll be asked to record the basic details of the person you are designing for, such as:

- What is their daily routine?
- Where do they live?
- What are their goals?

Each answer takes you a step closer to finding the right solution whilst also giving you a deeper understanding of user needs.

Empathy is at the heart of great design. Without it, the solutions you create can never truely solve the problems of your users.

Create the profile of your end-user

Capture the basic details about the person you are designing for and build a deeper understanding of their personality, wants and needs.

Personality map

Outgoing — Shy

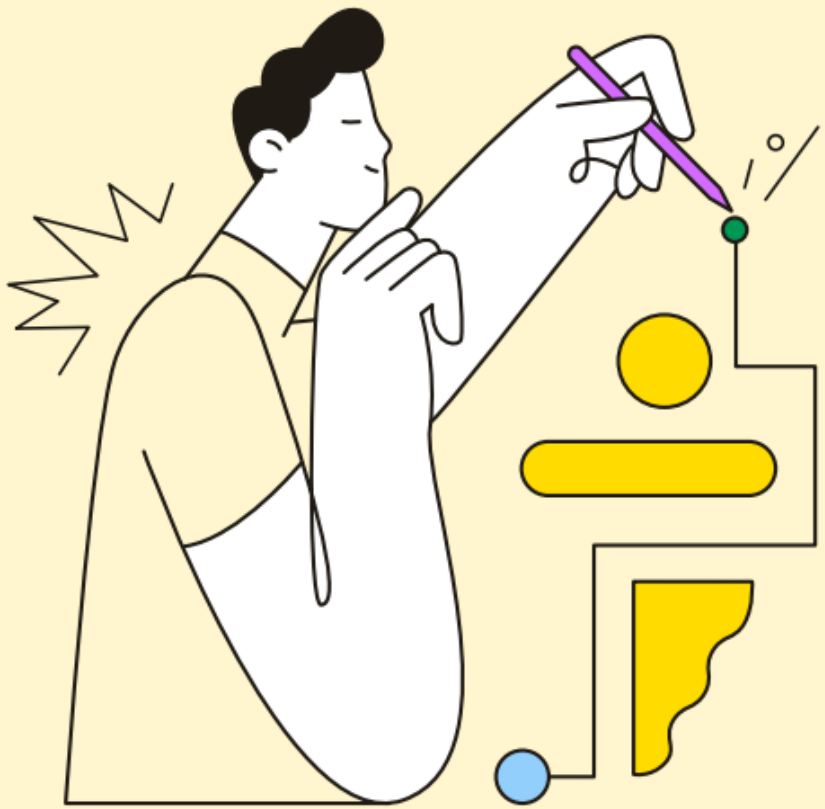
Serious — Fun

Generous — Selfish

Academic — Creative

Likes

Goals



Stage 02

Define a challenge

The big, meaty problem you want to solve for your business, customer and end-user.

Good design solves problems. What will you solve for your user?

Using what you learned in the last stage, it's time to discover a pain point to form a clear challenge that you can tackle.

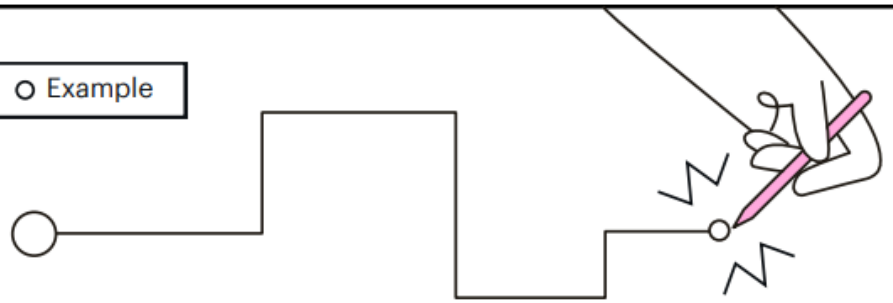
- **It's all about the end-user:** Remember this is more about the people you're trying to help than technology
- **Keep it focused:** Make sure the problem you are trying to tackle isn't too broad or vague
- **Check it against the Empathise stage:** Refer back to the user profile to make sure you're on the right track.

Once you've established a meaningful problem, you'll be able to brainstorm better solutions around it. Onwards!

Choose your challenge

Define the problem you are trying to solve for the end-user and why it's going to be important to them. Keep referring back to this as you go.

Example



What problem are you trying to solve for your end user?

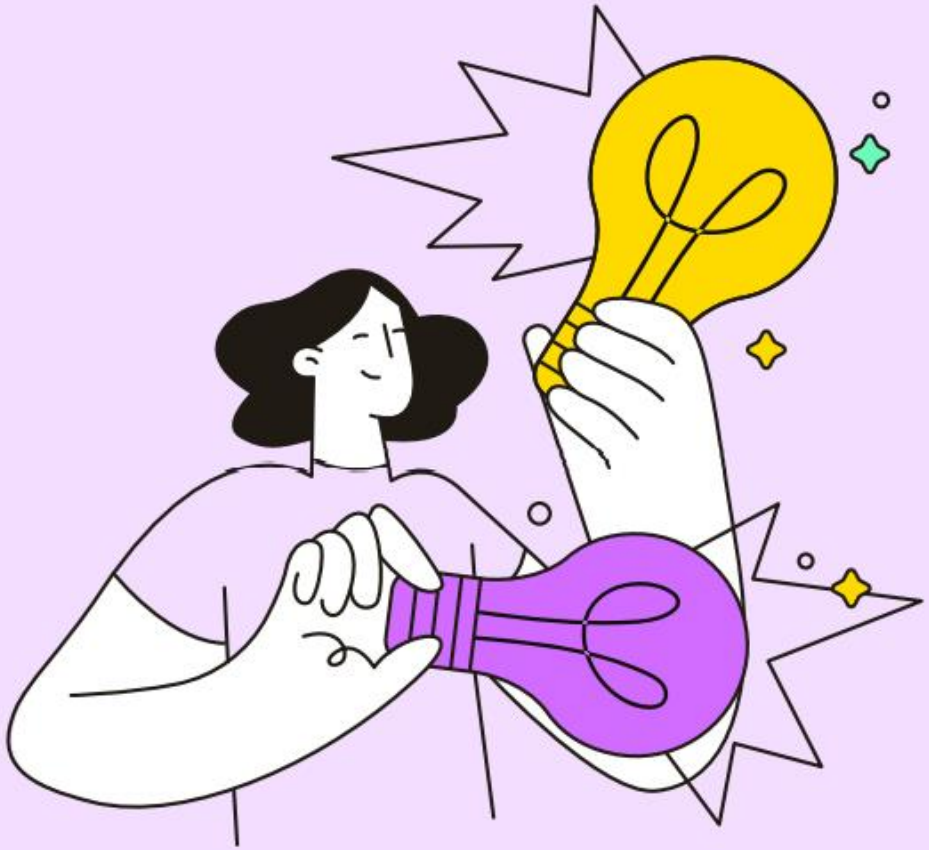
Find freelance teaching jobs on her phone

Why is this important to them?

As a freelance teacher Jules is often working in classrooms away from her laptop. That means she needs to quickly find and apply for new teaching slots on her phone before they get filled.

What problem are you trying to solve for your end user?

Why is this important to them?



Stage 03

Ideate possibilities

Generate ideas that might be useful to the end-user.

Now for the fun part! You know your user and the problem that needs to be solved. Let's start to brainstorm possible solutions.

The goal of ideation is to rapidly create enough simple and crazy ideas that apply to the problem so you can have a discussion to pick the best one.

- Generate as many ideas as possible
- Even the craziest ideas count!
- Anchor everything to the user profile and problems you defined in the previous stages

Remember to explore each idea with an open mind and that nothing is off the table!

Let's get started!

Simple ideas

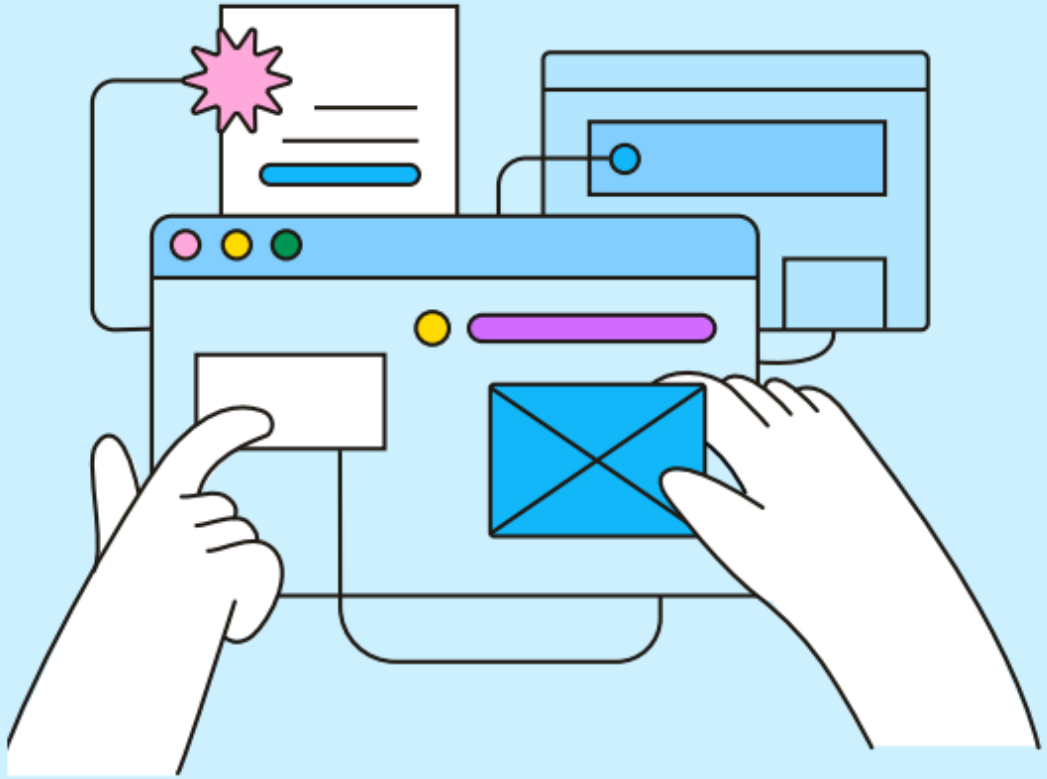
Practical, straightforward ideas that solve the problem.

Example Notifications when new jobs are live

Crazy Ideas

Sometimes the wild ideas pave the way to amazing solutions.

Example A Virtual Reality job board



Stage 04

Prototype your design

Turn ideas into realistic mockups that you can test.

Bring your ideas to life and create interactive prototypes, for mobile or web

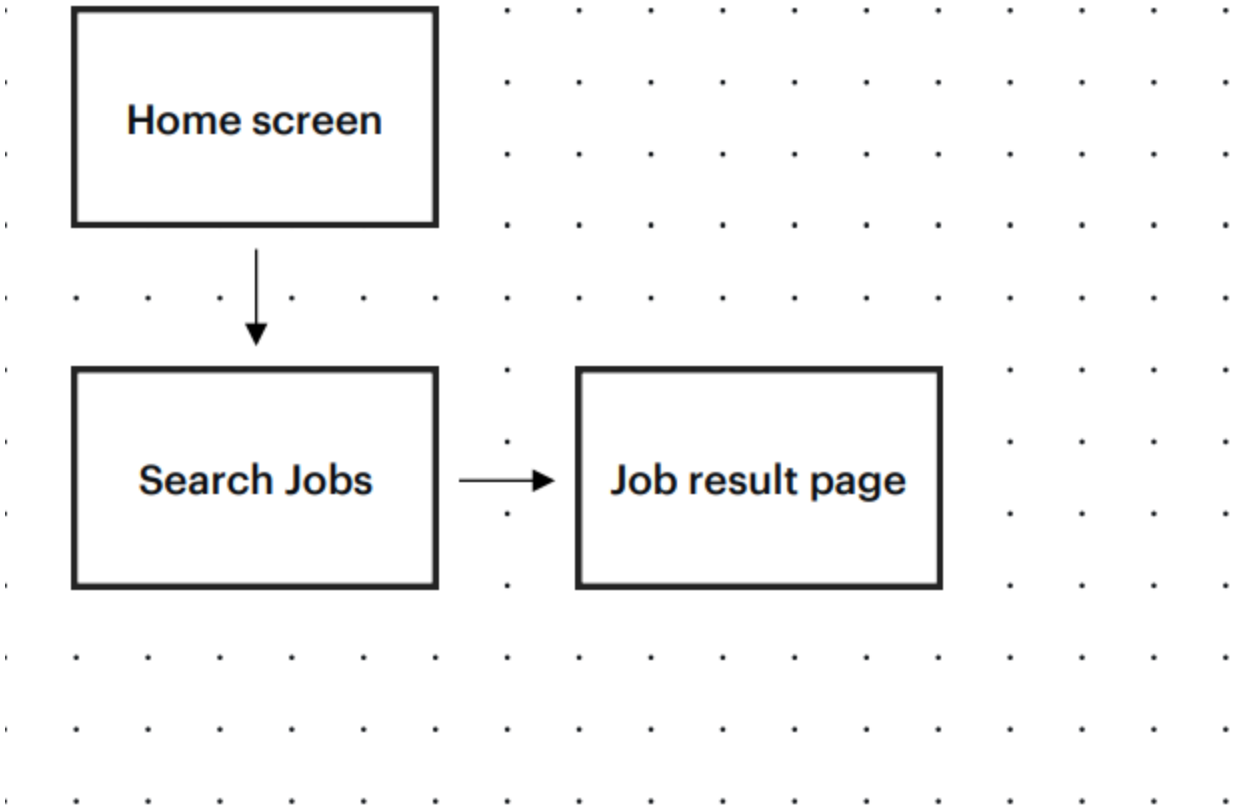
The best way to test ideas with users and start a conversation is to show them how the solution works. Prototyping is perfect for building your product ideas at speed and making them tangible.

Design your ideas through sketching on the paper templates

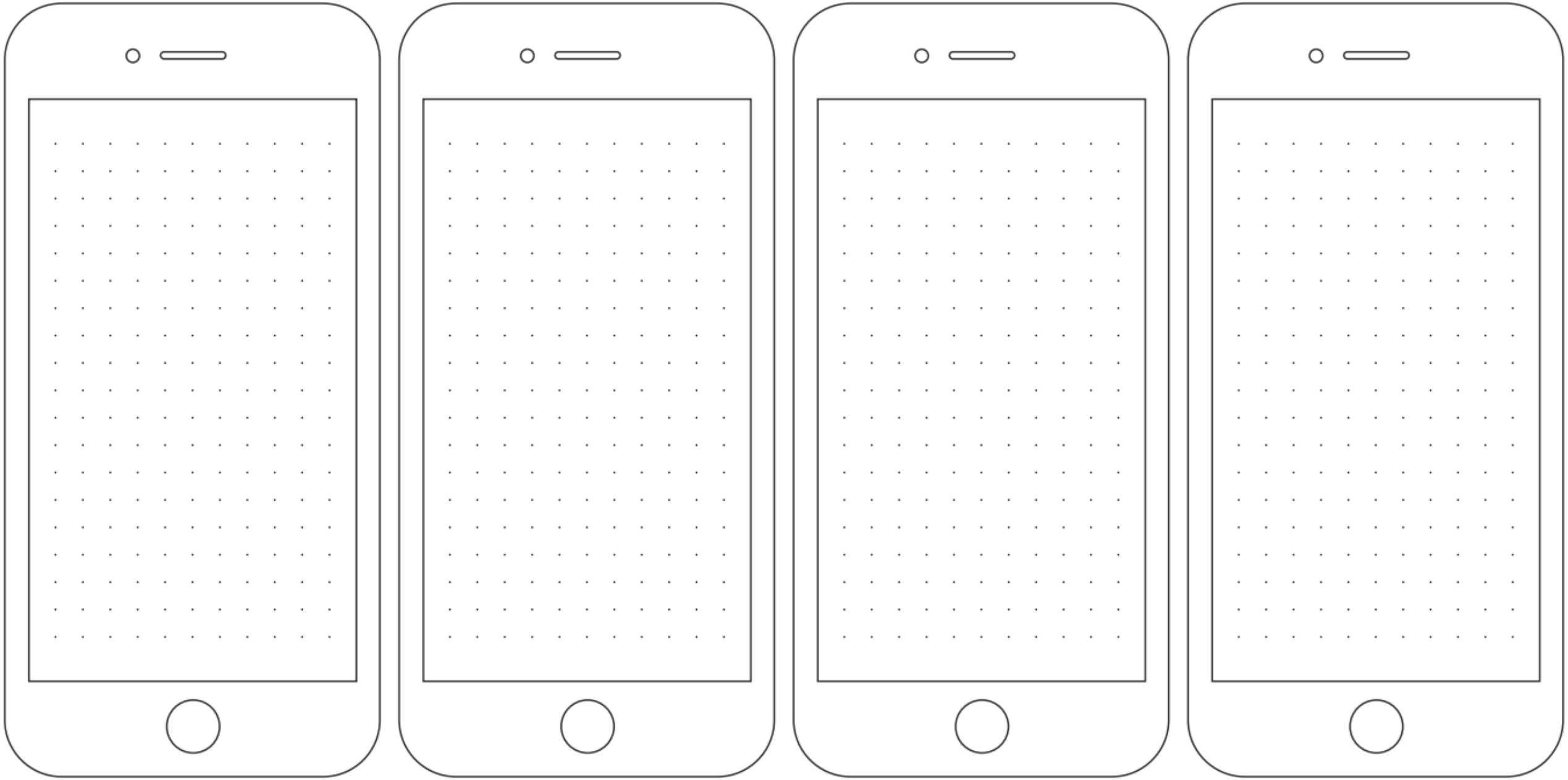
- Just start building, don't get hung up on visuals
- Don't spend too much time on one idea - move fast!
- Design only the screens that matter for testing

Sketch a flowchart of the user journey

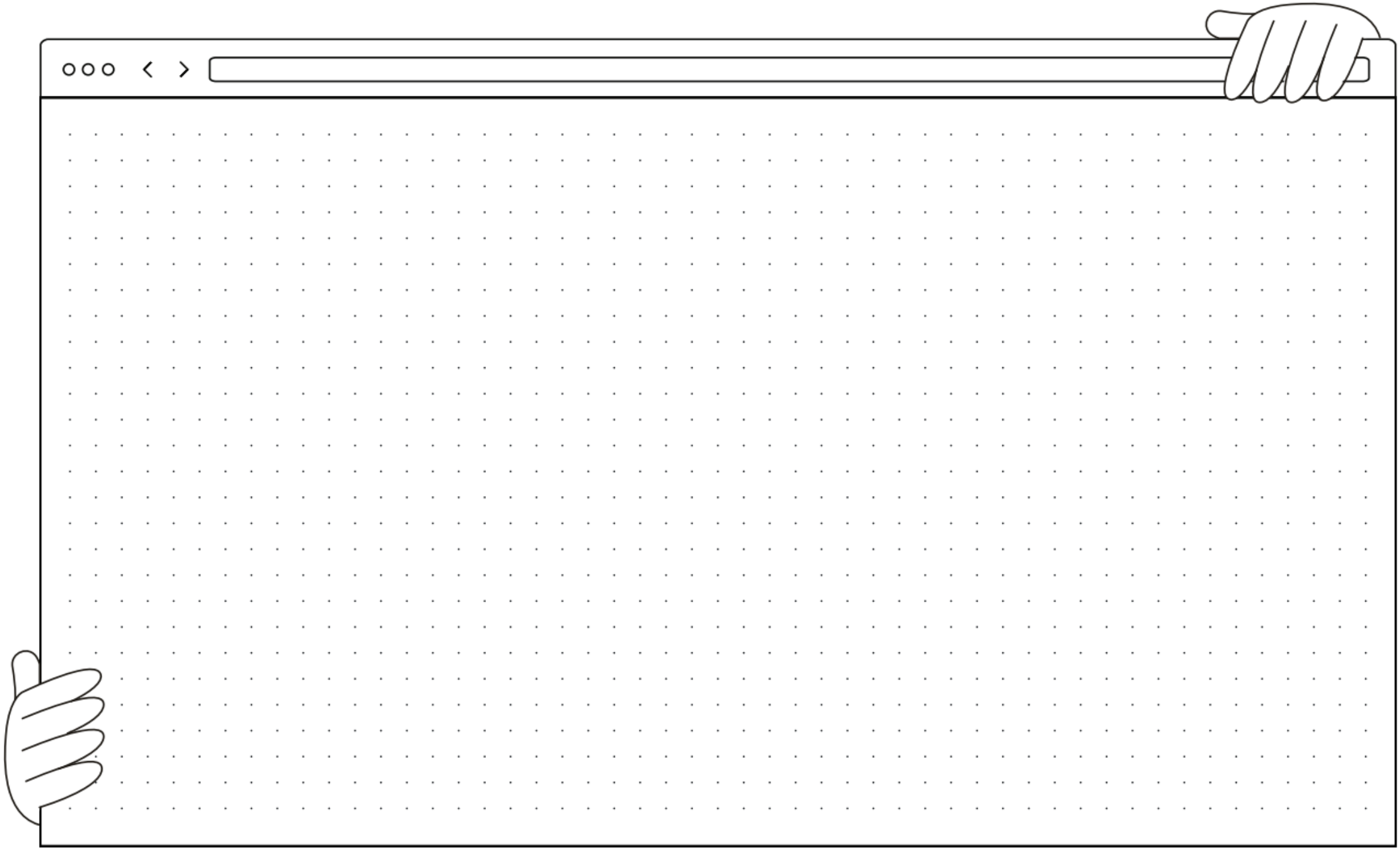
- A flowchart is a diagram that of steps your user will take and helps when you start designing



Let’s Start Sketching!!!



Sketch out your screens



Stage 05

Test your design

Share your prototype and gain invaluable feedback from the people that matter.

Test your prototype with your end user or simply others in the room

The Test stage helps you answer the question, 'how well does your prototype solve the problem you initially defined?'

The goal is to observe your user's reactions and behaviour with the prototype without giving instructions, then gather feedback that can be used to iterate and improve the experience.

Remember:

- Give them the sales pitch before using the prototype!
- Don't interrupt or try to take over, watch and learn!
- Identify where they hit issues or look confused

By the end, you should have a list of suggestions and next steps to take to improve your solution's overall experience.

Here is a design problem!

- Product Name: AskToExperts
- Problem:
  - When you have a question about something and you don't have someone to ask, you need to make a research for it and it can take lots of time.
  - What if there was an application with experts where you could ask questions?

- Main Requirements:
  - I want to search for an expert via my keywords or other useful filters
  - I want to see the list of related experts
  - I want to check details of the expert (name, age, cv, summary, available hours, response timei... what else can be useful?)
  - I want to start a chat with an expert